

K. J. Kevin Feng

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Research Interests

Human-computer interaction; social and collaborative computing; AI and society.

Education

- 2021 – **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Ph.D. Human Centered Design & Engineering
Advisors: David W. McDonald (HCDE), Amy X. Zhang (CSE)
- 2021 – 2023 M.S. Human Centered Design & Engineering
- 2017 – 2021 **Princeton University**, Princeton, NJ
B.S.E. Computer Science, Magna cum laude
Thesis: *Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale*
Advisor: Arvind Narayanan
Minors: technology & society, visual arts
- 01 – 05 2020 **National University of Singapore**, Singapore
Study Abroad, Computer Science

Publications

* denotes equal contribution. Acceptance rates for venues, when available, are in [square brackets].

REFEREED CONFERENCE AND JOURNAL PAPERS

- [c.11] Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Chan Young Park, Amy X. Zhang. SPICA: Retrieving Scenarios for Pluralistic In-Context Alignment. *Findings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL '25)*. Vienna, Austria. July 2025.
- [c.10] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Q. Vera Liao, Ziang Xiao, Jennifer Wortman Vaughan, Amy X. Zhang, David W. McDonald. Canvil: Designerly Adaptation for LLM-Powered User Experiences. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025. [24.9%].
- [c.9] Kevin Pu, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tovi Grossman, Tom Hope, Bhavana Dalvi Mishra, Matt Latzke, Jonathan Bragg, Joseph Chee Chang, Pao Siangliulue. IdeaSynth: Iterative Research Idea Development Through Evolving and Composing Idea Facets with Literature-Grounded Feedback. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025. [24.9%].

- [c.8] Inyoung Cheong, King Xia, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Amy X. Zhang. (A)I Am Not a Lawyer, But...: Engaging Legal Experts towards Responsible LLM Policies for Legal Advice. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '24)*. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. June 2024. [22.9%].
- [c.7] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Xander Koo, Lawrence Tan, Amy S. Bruckman*, David W. McDonald*, Amy X. Zhang*. Mapping the Design Space of Teachable Social Media Feed Experiences. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24)*. Honolulu, HI. May 2024. [26.3%].
- [c.6] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Nick Ritchie, Pia Blumenthal, Andy Parsons, Amy X. Zhang. Examining the Impact of Provenance-Enabled Media on Trust and Accuracy Perceptions. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW '23)*. Minneapolis, MN. October 2023. [32.7%].
- [c.5] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Maxwell James Coppock, David W. McDonald. How Do UX Practitioners Communicate AI as a Design Material? Artifacts, Conceptions, and Propositions. *ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '23)*. Pittsburgh, PA. July 2023. [24.0%].
- [c.4] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tony W. Li, Amy X. Zhang. Understanding Collaborative Practices and Tools of Professional UX Practitioners in Software Organizations. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23)*. Hamburg, Germany. April 2023. [28.4%].
- [c.3] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald. Addressing UX Practitioners' Challenges in Designing ML Applications: an Interactive Machine Learning Approach. *ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '23)*. Sydney, Australia. March 2023. [24.1%].
- [c.2] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Kevin Song, Kejing Li, Oishee Chakrabarti, Marshini Chetty. Investigating How University Students in the United States Encounter and Deal With Misinformation in Private WhatsApp Chats During COVID-19. *Eighteenth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS '22)*. Boston, MA. August 2022. [27.8%].
- [c.1] Ruoxi Shang, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Chirag Shah. Why Am I Not Seeing It? Understanding Lay Users' Needs in Counterfactual Explanations for Everyday Recommendations. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '22)*. Seoul, South Korea. June 2022. [25.2%].

PREPRINTS

- [p.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Kevin Pu, Matt Latzke, Tal August, Pao Siangliulue, Jonathan Bragg, Daniel S. Weld, Amy X. Zhang, Joseph Chee Chang. Cocoa: Co-Planning and Co-Execution with AI Agents. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.10999>.

LIGHTLY REFEREED PAPERS AND POSTERS

- [l.7]

K. J. Kevin Feng, Inyoung Cheong, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Amy X. Zhang. Policy Prototyping for LLMs: Pluralistic Alignment via Interactive and Collaborative Policymaking. *Bidirectional Human-AI Alignment workshop @ ICLR '25 (Oral)*. Singapore. April 2025.

- [l.6] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald, Amy X. Zhang. Levels of Autonomy for AI Agents. *Knight First Amendment Institute symposium: AI and Democratic Freedoms*. New York City, NY. April 2025.
- [l.5] Andrew Konya, Aviv Ovadya, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Lisa Schirch, Colin Irwin, Amy X. Zhang. Chain of Alignment: Integrating Public Will with Expert Intelligence for Language Model Alignment. *Pluralistic Alignment workshop @ NeurIPS '24*. Vancouver, Canada. December 2024.
- [l.4] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Inyoung Cheong, King Xia, Amy X. Zhang. Case Repositories: Towards Case-Based Reasoning for AI Alignment. *AI Meets Moral Philosophy and Moral Psychology (MP2) workshop @ NeurIPS '23*. New Orleans, LA. December 2023.
- [l.3] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald, Amy X. Zhang. Teachable Agents for End-User Empowerment in Personalized Feed Curation. *Knight First Amendment Institute symposium: Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society*. New York City, NY. April 2023. [18.9%].
- [l.2] **K. J. Kevin Feng***, Alice Gao*, Johanna S. Karras*. Towards Semantically Aware Word Cloud Shape Generation. *Adjunct Proceedings of the ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '22)*. Bend, OR. October 2022.
- [l.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Amy X. Zhang. From Handoffs to Co-Creation: Deepening Collaboration between Designers, Developers, and Data Science Workers in UX Design. *InContext Workshop @ CHI '22*. New Orleans, LA. May 2022.

WORKSHOPS ORGANIZED

- [w.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng***, Rock Yuren Pang*, Tzu-Sheng Kuo, Amy A. Winecoff, Emily Tseng, David Gray Widder, Harini Suresh, Katharina Reinecke, Amy X. Zhang. Sociotechnical AI Governance: Challenges and Opportunities for *Workshop at the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025.

THESES AND NON-REFEREED PAPERS

- [n.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng**. Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale. *Princeton University Department of Computer Science*. Princeton, NJ. April 2021.

Research Experience

Summer Fellow, **Centre for the Governance of AI**, London, United Kingdom
Collaborators: Risk Management Team (GovAI); Human Influence Team (UK AISI)
 Chain-of-thought monitoring for harmful manipulation from advanced AI.

- 06 – 08 2024 Research Intern, **Semantic Scholar, Allen Institute for AI**, Seattle, WA
Host: Joseph Chee Chang
 Co-planning and co-execution with AI agents in scientific research [p.1].
- 06 – 09 2023 Research Intern, **Fairness, Accountability, Transparency, and Ethics (FATE) Group, Microsoft Research**, Montréal, Canada
Host: Q. Vera Liao
 LLMs as UX design material [c.9].
- 01 2022 – Graduate Research Assistant, **Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering, University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Advisor: Amy X. Zhang
 Human-centered tools and methods for AI safety + alignment [c.8, w.4, w.5]; social media feed curation via machine teaching [c.7, w.3].
- 09 2021 – Graduate Research Assistant, **Human Centered Design & Engineering, University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Advisor: David W. McDonald
 Interactive machine learning for UX practitioners to design AI-powered applications [c.3, c.5, c.9].
- 08 2020 – Visiting Undergraduate Researcher, **University of Chicago AIRLab**, Remote
 07 2021 *Host: Marshini Chetty*
 COVID-19 misinformation in private WhatsApp chats [c.2].
- 06 2020 – Undergraduate Researcher, **Center for Information Technology Policy**, Princeton, NJ
 06 2021 *Advisor: Arvind Narayanan*
 AdOculus: a search platform and dataset for analyzing ads on the web, aided by computer vision [n.1].

Awards & Honours

- 2024 University of Washington nominee for Google PhD Fellowship
1 of 4 selected from UW Graduate School.
- 2023 OpenAI Democratic Inputs to AI grant
1 of 10 teams selected from 860+ worldwide.
- 2022 UW Herbold Fellowship
1 of 7 selected from UW College of Engineering.
- 2020 Princeton Council for Science and Technology Independent Project Award
- 2020 Princeton Office of Undergraduate Research Summer Research Award

2019 IDEO CoLab Fellowship Finalist
 2018 Keller Center for Innovation in Engineering Education Summer Fellow

Invited Talks & Panels

2025 **Designing for Interaction with Advanced AI**
 The Design Lab, UCSD
[Panel] AI Agents' Democratic and Economic Impacts
Artificial Intelligence and Democratic Freedoms, Knight First Amendment Institute
Cocoa: Co-Planning and Co-Execution with AI Agents
 Guest lecture, UW INFO 498: Understanding and Navigating Cognitive and Behavioral Change in the AI Era

2024 **Mapping the Design Space of Teachable Social Media Feed Experiences**
 Princeton HCI
Canvil: Supporting Designerly Model Adaptation in LLM-Powered User Experiences
 Guest lecture, UW HCDE 598: Human-Centeredness in Generative AI
Case Repositories: Towards Case-Based Reasoning for AI Alignment
 OpenAI Forum: Collective Alignment

2023 **Teachable Agents for End-User Empowerment in Personalized Feed Curation**
 Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory (MINT) Lab, Australian National University
Canvil: Supporting Designerly Model Adaptation in LLM-Powered User Experiences
 UW HCDE Academic Research Seminar
 Microsoft Research Montréal
 Microsoft Research FATE Group
 Microsoft Research HCI Seminar
[Panel] Empirical look at user behavior
Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society, Knight First Amendment Institute

2022 **User Perceptions of Media in Provenance-Enabled Social Media Feeds**
 Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity (C2PA) Technical Working Group

2021 **Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale**
 Princeton Research Day
 Princeton CITP Works in Progress Reading Group

2020 **User Interface Design, Prototyping, and Testing**
 Princeton ACM

2019 **Introduction to User Interface Design**
 HackPrinceton 2019

2018 **Introduction to User Interface Design**
 HackPrinceton 2018

Service

2021 – **Program Committee:** FAccT 2024–2025
Reviewing: CHI 2023–2025*, NeurIPS Pluralistic Alignment Workshop 2024, CHI LBW 2024*,

CSCW 2023–2024*, DIS 2023*, UIST 2022

** recognition for outstanding review(s).*

Student Volunteer: CHI 2023, IUI 2022, UIST 2022

Departmental Service: HCDE PhD Visit Days session leader, HCDE PhD orientation student panelist, HCDE PhD application reviewer

2020 – 2021 **Organizer**, Princeton intersession course on ethical technology

2019 – 2021 **First-year engineering student advisor**, Princeton School of Engineering and Applied Science

2018 – 2021 **Founder**, Rehack (reverse hackathon for development of more socially responsible technologies)

Mentoring

2025– **Jessica Do; Nancy Qu; Aditi Rana, Caleb West**, UW CSE BS, working on analyzing custom feeds on Bluesky.

2023–2024 **Lawrence Tan**, UW CSE BS, co-authored [c.7].

2022–2023 **Tony Li**, UW HCDE MS, co-authored [c.4].

Afterwards: PhD student at UCSD CSE.

2022–2023 **Maxwell Coppock**, UW HCDE BS, co-authored [c.5].

Afterwards: MS student at UW MHCI+D.

2022 **Amodini Khade**, UW HCDE MS.

2022 **Katrina Vergara**, UW HCDE MS.

Afterwards: Product Manager at Microsoft.

Industry Work Experience

06 – 09 2022 Program Manager Intern, **Responsible AI, Azure Machine Learning, Microsoft**, Bellevue, WA
Conducted research on the role of machine learning scorecards in facilitating multi-stakeholder conversations about model deployment.

06 – 08 2021 Program Manager Intern, **Data Platforms + Growth, Microsoft**, Remote
Launched UI for data analysts to better organize and take action on their data.

06 – 08 2019 Product Management Intern, **The Muse**, New York, NY
Built and launched new job search recommendation feature with a team of 2 engineers and a designer.

06 – 08 2018 Product Design Intern, **Solomoto**, Tel Aviv, Israel
Data dashboard design for small business management SaaS platform.

Skills

Technical: Python, JavaScript, Java, Unity, C, OCaml, Go, SQL, $\LaTeX$.

Other: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, qualitative and quantitative research methods, laser cutting, art exhibition installation, bookbinding, photography.

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